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Dissertation *“Essays on Spatial Development and the Environment”*
Thesis committee: [Roland Hodler](#) (primary advisor), [Beatrix Eugster](#), [Adam Storeygard](#), [Ferdinand Rauch](#)

Climate Change, Income Inequality, and Migration in a Spatial Economy (*Job market paper*)

This paper examines how differences in income shape individuals' migration responses to climate change and the resulting aggregate welfare implications. Standard quantitative spatial models predict that workers migrate away from climate-affected regions, thereby mitigating welfare losses; however, these models often fail to capture differences in migration behavior across the income distribution. Micro-level evidence suggests that low-income households often do not migrate despite significant potential gains from relocating. To reconcile these insights, I develop a dynamic quantitative spatial model that incorporates both monetary and non-monetary migration costs. Under decreasing marginal utility of income, these costs generate lower mobility among low-income workers. Climate change affects the model economy through two channels: first, by impacting agricultural productivity and resulting in income losses at the lower end of the income distribution; second, indirectly, by increasing the relative burden of monetary migration costs as average incomes decline. Calibration relies on aggregate migration flows. Simulations for Brazil (2010-2100) indicate that without migration, climate change reduces expected average lifetime utility by 2.2%. Migration at calibrated costs reduces welfare losses to 1.7%. Migration also mitigates the widening of regional and sectoral inequalities that climate change would otherwise induce.

Education **University of St.Gallen, Switzerland**
Ph.D., Economics, August 2020 - September 2025.
Primary fields: Economic Geography and International Trade.
Secondary fields: Environmental Economics and (Macro-) Development.
I will be on the academic job market in 25/26.

Tufts University, United States
Visiting J1 Research Scholar, August 2023 - June 2024.
Courses audited at MIT: International Trade I with Arnaud Costinot & International Trade II (first half) with Jose Vasquez.
Host: Adam Storeygard

Leibniz University Hannover, Germany
M.Sc., Economics, July 2020.
Graduated with distinction.

Research	Work in Progress • Climate Change, Income Inequality, and Migration in a Spatial Economy (<i>Job market paper</i>) • Skill Supply, Firm Size, and Economic Development (with Charles Gottlieb and Markus Poschke). ★ Featured in the “World Development Report 2024” • Infrastructure, language, and the making of a common market (with Roland Hodler and Paul Schaudt).
Teaching	University of St.Gallen, Switzerland Teaching Assistant, Political Economics (Master), 2021-22 Teaching Assistant, Economics of Climate Change (Bachelor), 2023 Teaching Assistant, Public Sector Economics (Bachelor), 2022-23; '25 Teaching Assistant, Development Economics (Bachelor), 2020-22; '24-25 Failed States and Nation Building (Master), 2024-25 Teaching Assistant, Data Handling: Import, Cleaning, and Visualization (Bachelor), 2021-23 Leibniz University Hannover, Germany Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Macroeconomics (Bachelor), 2017-19 Teaching Assistant, Operations Management (Bachelor), 2017
Conferences and Seminars	2025: <i>Development Economics Network Switzerland 2025 (Zürich, Switzerland), VfS Annual Conference 2025: Revival of industrial policy (Cologne, Germany), Political Economy of Global Development (Stuttgart, Germany)</i> 2024: <i>Tufts Economics and Public Policy Workshop (Medford, United States)</i> 2023: <i>North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Toronto, Canada), European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Milan, Italy), German Development Economics Conference (Dresden, Germany), Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (Neuchâtel, Switzerland), Warwick Economics PhD Conference (Coventry, UK), Young Swiss Economists Meeting (Zürich, Switzerland)</i>
Grants and Awards	• Mobility grant for doctoral students (47,333 CHF): 10-month research visit at Tufts University supported with a total grant of 47,333 CHF by the Research Committee of the University of St. Gallen. Host: Adam Storeygard. • Google Cloud Research Credits Program (1,015 USD): Awarded \$1,015 (USD) in Google Cloud Research Credits for computational implementation of job market paper.

- **Dean's List:** Awarded to the best 5% of the study cohort by the Faculty of Economics and Management of the Leibniz University Hannover

Skills

Programming Languages: Python, R, Matlab, C++, some Javascript

Other Coding: Git/GitHub, Docker

Geospatial Tools: ArcGIS, GRASS GIS, QGIS, Google Earth Engine

Machine Learning: Keras, Tensorflow

Personal

German citizen. Born 1996.